

MUTATION MISFIRE TABLE

☠	Your mutant powers run amok, and you suffer one point of permanent trauma. You choose which attribute is affected. At the same time, you develop a new mutation.
2	You suffer the effect of the mutation, and take as much trauma as your target. If the mutation doesn't cause trauma, you get disoriented instead and can't act at all in the next turn.
3	The mutation consumes twice the amount of MP you intended to spend on it – without increasing the effect. You can't drop below zero MP.
4	The mutation locks down after this use. You can't use it again for the rest of the session.
5	The mutation changes your appearance in some way. You choose how. The effect is only cosmetic, but it is permanent.
☢	The mutation gets supercharged. You get back the MP you just spent, and you can immediately – in the same turn – activate the same mutation again, against the same target or another.

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	BONUS	DAMAGE	RANGE	COMMENT
Unarmed	—	1	Arm's Length	
Blunt Instrument	+1	1	Arm's Length	
Bicycle Chain	+1	1	Near	
Brass Knuckles	+1	1	Arm's Length	Jury-Rigged. Light weapon.
Scrap Knife	+1	2	Arm's Length	Jury-Rigged. Light weapon.
Baseball Bat	+2	1	Arm's Length	Can be found in the Zone.
Bat with Spikes	+2	2	Arm's Length	Jury-Rigged.
Machete	+2	2	Arm's Length	Jury-Rigged.
Scrap Spear	+1	2	Near	Jury-Rigged.
Scrap Axe	+1	3	Arm's Length	Jury-Rigged. Heavy weapon.

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	BONUS	DAMAGE	RANGE	COMMENT
Thrown Rock	—	1	Short	
Slingshot	+1	1	Short	Jury-Rigged.
Bow	+1	1	Long	Jury-Rigged.
Scrap Pistol	+1	2	Short	Jury-Rigged.
Scrap Derringer	+1	1	Near	Jury-Rigged. Light weapon.
Scrap Rifle	+1	2	Long	Jury-Rigged.
Flamethrower	+1	2	Near	Jury-Rigged. Heavy weapon.
Scrap Cannon	+1	4	Long	Jury-Rigged. Can't be carried.

MUTANT

YEAR ZERO

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STARTER BOOKLET

Welcome to the Starter Booklet for *Mutant: Year Zero*. This booklet can be used in two different ways:

- ❑ As a stand-alone introduction to *Mutant: Year Zero*. The character playbooks in the center of the booklet contain condensed rules for playing the game. Using only this booklet and some six-sided dice (preferably the custom Mutant dice, but any dice will do in a pinch), you can play an introductory game of *Mutant: Year Zero* – perfect for cons or introducing new players to the game!
- ❑ As a Zone Compendium, for use with the full *Mutant: Year Zero* game. The main part of the booklet describes three Special Zone Sectors that you, the Gamemaster, can place anywhere you like on the Zone map.

SPECIAL ZONE SECTORS

Special Zone Sectors are complete scenario locations and contain NPCs, conflicts and events for the PCs to get involved in. There are a large number of Special Zone Sectors already published for *Mutant: Year Zero*, in the core book as well as in previous Zone Compendia. The Special Zone Sectors are generally stand-alone scenarios that can be played in any order.

The three sectors in this booklet are a little different – they are written to give you a good

introduction to *Mutant: Year Zero* and are designed to be played in order. The first sector – *A New Kind of Beast* – is written as a starting point of the game. If you already have a *Mutant: Year Zero* campaign, you can play these sectors in any order you like.

Every Special Zone Sector has a map overview, which is available in two versions.

- ❑ The GM map has small picture inlays showing details of specific locations in the sector.
- ❑ The player map does not include these inlays, and can be shown to the players when the PCs arrive in the sector. The player maps can be found in the middle of this booklet, and will be available to download from the Modiphuis website.

ONLY FOR GAMEMASTERS!

The rest of this booklet is for the Gamemaster's eyes only. If you are a player, reading past this point might spoil the fun for you and for the rest of the group. The exception is the four character playbooks in the center of the booklet – once removed, players are free to read and use them.

GETTING STARTED

To start playing *Mutant: Year Zero*, follow these simple steps:

1. Carefully remove the playbooks and the Zone map in the center of this booklet.
2. Choose jointly in the group which Zone map (there is one on each side) that you want to place your game in.
3. Decide on which sector (square on the map) to place the characters' settlement, the Ark, in. It must be a sector by the waterside.
4. Let the players choose among the four playbooks, and have them create their characters according to the guidelines within.
5. Start playing *A New Kind of Beast* (page 14), the first of three Special Zone Sectors in this booklet.

CHARACTER PLAYBOOKS

The center of the booklet contains four *character playbooks*. Remove these carefully. Each *playbook* includes a character sheet and condensed rules for creating a PC and for playing the game. Given the limited space, only a limited section of the game rules is covered. For full game rules, please see the *Mutant: Year Zero* core rulebook.

NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

As the *Gamemaster*, you control acid rains, Zone monsters, and deadly automatons – but your most important tools are the non-player characters (NPCs). Use the NPCs that your player characters have relationships to (see the playbooks), to create suspense and drama.

The three Zone sectors described in the next chapter contain NPCs ready for use. The *Mutant: Year Zero* core rulebook details the rules for creating your own NPCs.

MANAGING NPCs

Generally, NPCs follow the same rules PCs (see the playbooks) – they use skills, use mutations, and suffer trauma in the same way. However, you can disregard the rules when managing your NPCs as long as their actions do not directly affect a PC. You don't need to keep track of the water and grub rations of an NPC accompanying the PCs into the Zone – instead, you simply decide when they run out of supplies, as dramatically appropriate. Don't roll dice for NPC actions unless they attack (or attempt to Heal) a PC. You *can* roll dice for NPCs in other situations as well, if the roll heightens the drama, but this is generally not necessary.



NPCS AND MUTATIONS

NPCs have mutations just like PCs, they don't have individual MP pools. Instead, you get a pool of MP to spend on all your NPCs.

At the start of every session, you get a number of MP equal to the number of your players' MP pooled together. Include the new MP that the players get at the start of the session (one for every mutation their PC has).

You can gain more MP during play by pushing skill rolls, just like the players. Unlike the players however, you may *not* save MP between sessions. You simply start each session with as many MP as the players' total combined.

Use you MP to create maximum possible suspense. Have your NPCs activate their mutations to toughen the challenge for the PCs when needed, not just because you have MP left to spend. It is fine to have MP left unspent at the end of the session.

ZONE TRAVEL

An important part of *Mutant: Year Zero* is the Zone travel – expeditions out into the barren wasteland, searching for food, artifacts, or knowledge. The core rulebook contains full rules for Zone travel and describes how you as the GM can fill the sectors of the Zone map with dangers and mysteries for the PCs to explore. The condensed guidelines below can be used to play the first few treks into the Zone.

EXPLORATION

The squares on the Zone map are called sectors, and each sector is roughly 1 × 1 mile in size. The PCs travel from sector to sector, diagonally if they wish. Every time the PCs enter a new sector, they have to *explore* it. You describe the scene to the PCs, and they tell you what they wish to examine closer. During the exploration they may well encounter all kinds of threats, but they can also find rare artifacts.



Time and Travel: One sector in the Zone takes about four hours to explore, including encounters along the way. This may sound like a long time, but bear in mind that the Zone is a maze of ruins, reclaimed by nature, and that the PCs must proceed very carefully.

Nighttime: Only fools travel the Zone by night. All exploration takes twice as long, and both Zone Ghouls and even more terrifying monsters usually come out at night.

Back Again? When the PCs have explored a sector, they will not have to explore that sector again later. They will have found a good route and can pass through it without further troubles. This will take about one hour. Normally, no new threats or artifacts will appear in already explored sectors, but you are free to make exceptions – the players should never feel safe in the Zone!

SECTOR ENVIRONMENT

When the PCs enter a new sector, start by describing the general environment to them. Create your own scene, or roll D66 on the table below. To roll D66, roll two D6, counting the first die as the tens number and the second as the ones.

You can, and should, modify the sector environment to better fit into the general environment of the Zone as a whole.



D66	ENVIRONMENT	RUIN	THREAT	ARTIFACT
11–12	Thick Woods	No	Yes	No
13–15	Scrublands	No	Yes	No
16–21	Marshlands	No	Yes	No
22–24	Dead Woods	No	Yes	No
25–26	Ash Desert	No	Yes	No
31	Huge Crater	No	Yes	No
32	Glasified Field	No	Yes	No
33–35	Overgrown Ruins	Yes	Yes	Yes
36–42	Crumbling Ruins	Yes	Yes	Yes
43–51	Decayed Ruins	Yes	Yes	Yes
52–56	Unscathed Ruins	Yes	Yes	Yes

D66	ENVIRONMENT	RUIN	THREAT	ARTIFACT
61–64	Derelict Industries	Yes	Yes	Yes
65–66	Settlement*	—	—	—

The columns Ruin, Threat and Artifact tell you if there typically is an explorable ruin in the sector, if there is a presence of threats, and if there is chance to find artifacts. Remember, these are just guidelines, not rules – you are free to place ruins, threats and artifacts in any sectors you like.

THREAT ROLL

After establishing the general environment in a sector, roll five dice without the players seeing the outcome. For every one (or ☠ symbol, if you use the custom dice) you roll, there is a threat in the sector. Roll D66 on the table on the next page, or just pick which threat you want the players to encounter. You are free to modify the description of the threat as you see fit.

Know the Zone: When the PCs encounter a threat, they may make a Know the Zone roll to figure out more about the threat. If the roll succeeds, you can tell the players some extra details, but not everything there is to know.

Monsters: Several of the threats listed in the table are monsters of one kind or another. Monsters have attributes and skills just like the PCs, but have no MP and can never push their rolls. Most monsters lack the attributes Wits and Empathy, and can therefore never suffer confusion or doubt. Some monsters also lack Agility, and can never suffer fatigue. When a monster's Strength is reduced to 0, it is dead. Many more Zone monsters can be found in the *Mutant: Year Zero* core rulebook and in *Mutant: Genlab Alpha*.

Artifacts: For every six (or ☢ symbol, if you use the custom dice) on your threat roll, the sector contains a valuable artifact from the Old Age. Read more about artifacts below.